A new road was planned for the spring, although the council had promised the same thing for eleven years. Every Friday the musicians gathered near the fountain and played songs that their grandparents had taught them. By evening the market stalls were gone, and only the smell of bread and oranges remained in the square.

Some people said the town had not changed in a century, while others insisted that everything was different now. When the rain finally arrived, it

Every Friday the musicians gathered near the fountain and played songs that their grandparents had taught them. Children walked to school along the canal, counting boats and arguing about which one was the fastest. In the afternoon the light turned gold, and the old clock in the square ran four minutes late, as it always had.

The river town woke slowly, and the baker opened his shutters before the first cart rolled over the bridge. A new road was planned for the spring, although the council had promised the same thing for eleven years. In the afternoon the light turned gold, and the old clock in the square ran four minutes late, as it always had.